unprecedented scrutiny. If the coverage of the AAP during the assembly election campaign bordered on the euphoric, it was now openly hostile in some news networks. ‘Hashtag aggression’—an euphemism for agenda-driven ‘supari’ journalism—saw Kejriwal being targeted with tags like #AAPAnarchy, #AAPDrama, #AAPIntolerant, #AAPMobocracy on Twitter. Kejriwal was convinced that the ‘corporate’ media under Modi’s instructions was behind the campaign. When we did a critical story around the Rajpath dharna, I got a call from one of Kejriwal’s aides who said, ‘Looks like Modi has bought you guys too!’ Paranoia had now set in.

The BJP was delighted that Kejriwal had pressed the self-destruct button. Party leaders like Subramanian Swamy were ‘assigned’ to find anything they could to undermine the AAP leader’s credibility. ‘I will expose this corrupt guy,’ Swamy told me with relish. He had apparently been promised a Lok Sabha ticket for his efforts. The promise would not be met. Nor would Kejriwal’s ‘corruption’ be revealed.

The underclass in the slums and *jhuggi*s who had voted for AAP were still firmly with Kejriwal. I remember a street vendor telling me that for the first time the constables were scared of taking *hafta* for fear of being ‘stung’. But the middle class and the opinion makers who had been swayed by AAP’s rhetoric were now losing faith. It was only a matter of time before AAP scripted its own obituary.

I was in Mumbai attending an award function on Valentine’s Day morning when the rumours began to swirl that Kejriwal was about to resign because the Opposition in the Delhi assembly wasn’t going to support his Jan Lokpal bill. My hosts asked me why I wasn’t in the studio to anchor the impending breaking news. I rather cynically replied, ‘Don’t worry, Kejriwal won’t resign in the morning, he will only step down, if he does, in prime time!’

Sure enough, around 6 p.m., the story began to gather momentum. A meeting of the AAP’s political affairs core group had been called to take a decision on whether to step out of the government. I was still in Mumbai and rang up Yogendra Yadav to find out more. ‘I am just entering the committee meeting. No decision has been taken yet, but I think we should